

BTS Star RM Shares His Art Collection, and Fans Flock to the Museum

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RM, the leader of the K-pop band BTS, is showing art from his own **collection** at a museum for the first time. The San Francisco Museum of Modern Art, called SFMOMA, has been packed with fans eager to see it.

The show is called "RM x SFMOMA: Between You and Me." It has more than 170 works, mostly from RM's **collection**, with a few pieces from the museum, such as a painting by Mark Rothko shown next to one by Korean artist Yun Hyong-keun. The museum's gift shop said it stocked more **souvenirs** than for any **exhibition** before.

RM, whose real name is Kim Nam-joon, is 32. He began visiting museums and collecting art nearly a decade ago. Art has **inspired** some of his songs. His **collection** focuses on Korean artists from ancient times to today. BTS fans, known as ARMY, even made up a word, "Namjooning," for doing the things he loves, like visiting museums.

RM said he asked two questions when choosing art: Does it really move him, and does it still have something to say to people today? He called the show "a pretty long introduction" to himself.

Fans Bre Walker and Joi Karra visited on the first **preview** day. Walker said it was her first time ever in an art museum. In one section, they spotted seven carved wooden ducks and wondered if it was a nod to the seven members of BTS. A rock carved with the word "candy" left them puzzled, which seemed **fitting** in a section called "I don't know ... but I like it."

Fans also shared handmade gifts. One visitor flew in from Zambia. After her visit, Walker said, "I'll be back."

Word Treasure

exhibition -- A public show of art or other objects.

souvenirs -- Items people buy to remember a place or event.

collection -- A group of objects someone has gathered, often over many years.

inspired -- Gave someone the idea or feeling to create something.

preview -- A chance to see something before it officially opens.

fitting -- Suitable or right for the situation.

Background you need

Art museums display paintings, sculptures and other works so the public can see and learn from them.

Some collectors lend or show their private art so others can enjoy it, often working with museum curators to plan the show.

BTS is a K-pop group from South Korea with seven members and a huge worldwide fanbase called ARMY.

Many of the works in RM's collection are by Korean artists from ancient times to today.

Break it down

LEAD: BTS leader RM shows his personal art collection at SFMOMA for the first time

KEY EVENT: Exhibition 'RM x SFMOMA: Between You and Me' draws crowds

+ - WHO: RM (Kim Nam-joon), 32, and BTS fans

+ - WHAT: More than 170 works, mostly from his collection

+ - WHERE: San Francisco Museum of Modern Art

BACKGROUND: RM began collecting art nearly a decade ago; fans call it Namjooning

FAN VIEW: Seven carved ducks and a puzzling 'candy' rock

ENDING: A first-time museum visitor says she will be back

Why it matters

A pop star's love of art is bringing many young fans into a museum for the first time, showing how music and art can inspire each other.

Test what you remember

1. Which museum is showing RM's art collection?

- ☐ (A) The Museum of Modern Art in New York
- ☐ (B) The National Museum of Korea
- ☐ (C) The San Francisco Museum of Modern Art
- ☐ (D) The Louvre

2. About how many works are in the show?

- ☐ (A) More than 170
- ☐ (B) More than 17
- ☐ (C) More than 1,700
- ☐ (D) More than 70

3. What is RM's real name?

- ☐ (A) Kim Nam-joon
- ☐ (B) Mark Rothko
- ☐ (C) Wonwoo Lee
- ☐ (D) Yun Hyong-keun

4. What word did fans make up for doing the things RM loves?

- ☐ (A) Armying
- ☐ (B) Rapping
- ☐ (C) Namjooning
- ☐ (D) Collecting

5. What did fans think the seven carved ducks might stand for?

- ☐ (A) Seven museum floors
- ☐ (B) The seven days of the week
- ☐ (C) Seven Korean artists
- ☐ (D) The seven members of BTS

6. What section name fit the puzzling 'candy' rock?

- ☐ (A) Between You and Me
- ☐ (B) Friendscape
- ☐ (C) Still Life
- ☐ (D) I don't know ... but I like it

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: A 4: C 5: D 6: D

Questions to think about

1. **RM: Says he chose works that truly moved him and still have something to say today, calling the show a long introduction to himself.**
2. **Fan Bre Walker: Says it was her first time in an art museum and she will be back.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):